

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 22

Group 22 Vocabulary

1. Arresting

Meaning: Very attractive, striking, or attention-grabbing.

Tip to remember: Arresting sounds like “arrest.” If something is arresting, it stops your attention like an arrest.

Sentence: The speaker gave an arresting introduction that captured everyone’s attention.

2. Chastise

Meaning: To scold or criticize someone severely.

Tip to remember: Think of a teacher chasing a student with words for bad behavior. That is chastising.

Sentence: The coach chastised the players for their careless mistakes.

3. Cumbersome

Meaning: Large, heavy, awkward, or difficult to handle.

Tip to remember: Think of carrying a huge box through a narrow door. It is cumbersome.

Sentence: The old equipment was too cumbersome to move easily.

4. Economy

Meaning: Careful use of resources; simplicity and efficiency.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: economy does not always mean finance; it can mean avoiding waste.

Sentence: The writer used economy of words to make the essay concise.

5. Elementary

Meaning: Basic, simple, or introductory.

Tip to remember: Think of elementary school, where students learn basic ideas.

Sentence: The course begins with elementary concepts before moving to advanced topics.

6. Embellish

Meaning: To decorate or make something more attractive; to add extra details, sometimes false ones.

Tip to remember: Embellish sounds like “make beautiful.” You embellish a story

by adding attractive details.

Sentence: He embellished his story to make it sound more exciting.

7. **Euphoric**

Meaning: Extremely happy and excited.

Tip to remember: Think of the feeling after receiving your dream university acceptance. That feeling is euphoric.

Sentence: She was euphoric after winning the scholarship.

8. **Exonerate**

Meaning: To clear someone from blame or guilt.

Tip to remember: “Ex” means out, and “onerate” relates to burden. Exonerate means to take the burden of blame off someone.

Sentence: The new evidence exonerated the accused student.

9. **Extrapolate**

Meaning: To estimate or predict based on known information.

Tip to remember: Think of extending a graph line beyond the known points. That is extrapolating.

Sentence: The researcher extrapolated future demand from past electricity data.

10. **Falter**

Meaning: To hesitate, weaken, or lose strength.

Tip to remember: Falter sounds like “fall.” When confidence falters, it starts to fall.

Sentence: His voice faltered during the difficult part of the speech.

11. **Fervent**

Meaning: Very passionate, intense, or enthusiastic.

Tip to remember: Fervent sounds like “fever.” A fervent person has fever-like passion.

Sentence: She is a fervent supporter of clean energy.

12. **Foment**

Meaning: To stir up or encourage trouble, rebellion, or strong feeling.

Tip to remember: Think of adding fuel to fire. Foment means to stir up unrest.

Sentence: The speech fomented anger among the workers.

13. **Gaffe**

Meaning: An embarrassing social mistake.

Tip to remember: Gaffe sounds like “goof.” A gaffe is a public goof or mistake.

Sentence: Calling the guest by the wrong name was a serious gaffe.

14. **Heterodox**

Meaning: Not following accepted beliefs or opinions; unconventional.

Tip to remember: “Hetero” means different, and “dox” means opinion. Heterodox means different from common opinion.

Sentence: His heterodox theory challenged traditional economics.

15. **Histrionic**
Meaning: Overly dramatic or theatrical.
Tip to remember: Think of an actor exaggerating emotions on stage. That behavior is histrionic.
Sentence: Her histrionic reaction made the small problem seem huge.
16. **Implicit**
Meaning: Suggested but not directly stated; understood without words.
Tip to remember: Implicit means hidden inside the statement, not openly said.
Sentence: There was an implicit agreement that everyone would help with the project.
17. **Inviolate**
Meaning: Safe from violation, damage, or attack; untouched.
Tip to remember: Inviolate means “not violated.” Something inviolate remains protected and pure.
Sentence: The constitution treats certain rights as inviolate.
18. **Liability**
Meaning: A disadvantage, burden, or legal responsibility.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: liability often means weakness, not only legal debt.
Sentence: His lack of communication skills became a liability during the interview.
19. **Obstinate**
Meaning: Stubborn and refusing to change one’s opinion.
Tip to remember: Obstinate sounds like “obstacle.” An obstinate person is like an obstacle that refuses to move.
Sentence: The obstinate student refused to accept helpful feedback.
20. **Painstaking**
Meaning: Done with great care, effort, and attention to detail.
Tip to remember: Painstaking work takes so much care that it almost feels painful.
Sentence: The researcher made a painstaking analysis of the data.
21. **Phlegmatic**
Meaning: Calm, unemotional, and not easily excited.
Tip to remember: Think of a person staying calm even when everyone else panics. That person is phlegmatic.
Sentence: The phlegmatic manager handled the crisis calmly.
22. **Prodigious**
Meaning: Very large, impressive, or extraordinary.
Tip to remember: Prodigious sounds like “prodigy.” A prodigy has extraordinary ability.
Sentence: She has a prodigious memory for vocabulary.
23. **Propensity**
Meaning: A natural tendency or inclination.

Tip to remember: Think of your mind being pulled toward a habit. That pull is propensity.

Sentence: He has a propensity to procrastinate before exams.

24. **Qualm**

Meaning: A feeling of doubt, worry, or moral uneasiness.

Tip to remember: Qualm sounds like “calm,” but it is the opposite: inner discomfort.

Sentence: She had no qualms about reporting the dishonest behavior.

25. **Reneg**

Meaning: To go back on a promise or agreement.

Tip to remember: Reneg sounds like “reject agreement.” If you renege, you break your promise.

Sentence: The company reneged on its promise to pay bonuses.

26. **Stinting**

Meaning: Giving or spending very little; ungenerous.

Tip to remember: Think of someone giving only a tiny stint of help. Stinting means limited and ungenerous.

Sentence: His stinting support made the project difficult to complete.

27. **Temper**

Meaning: To soften, moderate, or reduce the force of something; also, mood.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: temper can mean control or soften, not only anger.

Sentence: The professor tempered his criticism with encouragement.

28. **Tentative**

Meaning: Not certain or final; hesitant.

Tip to remember: Tentative sounds like “testing.” A tentative plan is still being tested, not fixed.

Sentence: They made a tentative schedule for the research work.

29. **Unprecedented**

Meaning: Never done or seen before.

Tip to remember: Precedent means earlier example. Unprecedented means there is no earlier example.

Sentence: The country experienced unprecedented growth in solar power.

30. **Vivacious**

Meaning: Lively, energetic, and cheerful.

Tip to remember: Vivacious sounds like “vivid.” A vivacious person is full of vivid life and energy.

Sentence: Her vivacious personality made the class more enjoyable.